Further reading: Frauwallner 1995; Halbfass 1992; Potter 1996

Avayavin (whole object): in contrast to the Buddhist reduction of what appear to be continuous objects to temporary collections of atomic factors and to the early ***Samkhya*** view that stable objects are just conglomerations of properties, the ***Nyaya-Vaisheshika*** school holds that persisting objects result from causal processes (***Asatkaryavada***) as integrated wholes. The whole is a new creation with its own identity, over and above the sum of the parts in which it inheres. The whole entity cannot exist without the parts, but the parts can exist without the whole. It is distinct from the parts since it manifests a single specific universal. An individual object must be the substrate of a universal, such as cowness or potness – a collection of different parts will not suffice. That the whole is not reducible to its parts is crucial to the ***Nyaya-Vaisheshikas***' resistance to the Buddhist reduction of objects to constituents and phases. Endurance through space and time is explained in terms of integrated natures that are held together by inherence (***samavaya***). The continued existence of wholes requires that they retain all their parts over time. A partial replacement means the end of one whole and the generation of a new, similar one.

Further reading: Halbfass 1992

Avidya (ignorance): this has two senses: simple of lack of knowledge, and being wrong about something. In the first case, it is an absence but in the second it means a misconception that is mistaken for knowledge. Spiritual ignorance fuels the fires of rebirth. In many forms of Hinduism and Jainism, it condemns the eternal pure soul, its true nature lost from view, to a series of embodiments and, in Buddhism, propels the many streams of